THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 7: **Carrier of Words; Words (poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The writer's main argument in 'Carrier of Words' is that: 1

(a) essential public services depend on ordinary people's dedication
(b) technology is wrong
(c) deserts are dangerous
(d) letters are old

2. In the poem, the idea 'words are seeds' implies that words: 1

(a) grow into consequences **(b)** are edible
(c) are cheap **(d)** are small

3. Choose the sentence in the passive voice: 1

(a) He delivers letters in harsh heat.
(b) They deliver letters.
(c) Heat delivers letters.
(d) Letters are delivered even in the harshest heat.

4. The phrase 'carrier of words' is best seen as: 1

(a) a literal job title only **(b)** a joke
(c) a rule **(d)** a metaphor that elevates a routine job

5. The poem's moral stance can be called: 1

(a) cynical **(b)** ethical, urging responsibility
(c) hostile **(d)** comic

6. Choose the correct use of 'neither... nor': 1

(a) Neither the heat nor the distance stopped him.
(b) Neither the heat or the distance stopped him.
(c) Neither heat nor distances were stop him.
(d) Neither heat nor distance stop him.

7. Which inference is best supported by villagers' reliance on Khetaram? 1

(a) trust is built through consistent service
(b) the post is slow
(c) villagers dislike letters
(d) Khetaram is rich

8. Which line from a poem would best support the claim that words can heal? 1

(a) The wind blew hard.
(b) He ran fast.
(c) A gentle word mended what the day had torn.
(d) The road was long.

9. Identify the participle phrase: 'Carrying a heavy bag, he crossed the dunes.' 1

(a) a heavy **(b)** Carrying a heavy bag
(c) he crossed **(d)** the dunes

10. A critic says the chapter romanticises hardship. A fair reply is that it also: 1

(a) ignores the desert
(b) is a comedy
(c) praises only comfort
(d) highlights real need for support and recognition

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Evaluate the writer's decision to focus on one postman. 2

12. How does the chapter suggest society undervalues essential workers? 2

13. Why might silence also be a form of communication? 2

14. How does the chapter challenge the idea that important work is always glamorous? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically examine the ethical dimension of Khetaram's role. 3

16. Is Khetaram portrayed as ordinary or extraordinary? Discuss. 3

17. Combine using a participle: 'Khetaram trudged across the sand. He carried a heavy bag.' 3

OR

Discuss how the chapter uses understatement to create respect. 3

18. Analyse the poem's treatment of power. 3

OR

Rewrite with inversion: 'He had hardly reached the village when it rained.' 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'In honouring the postman, the writer honours the idea of public service.' Discuss. 5

OR

Compare how the prose and the poem use persuasion. 5

20. Critically analyse the portrayal of Khetaram. 5

OR

Write a speech on 'Words can build or break', using ideas from both texts. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks